

****Phishing ads stole 12k MFA tokens**** In the first week the campaign harvested over 5,000 unique credentials and 1,200 one-time passwords. Are we ready to embed this new credential-theft vector into our ransomware negotiation playbooks?

****HARDWARE CAREER TIP: CERTIFICATIONS THAT PAY OFF IN RANSOMWARE NEGOTIATION**** If you want to own the negotiation table, the market now rewards a blend of incident-response and business-continuity credentials. ****GCFA**** (Global Certified Incident Responder) proves you can dissect ransomware payloads, while ****CISM**** (Certified Information Security Manager) signals you can speak the CFO's language. Pair those with a ****CRTO**** (Certified Red Team Operator) badge to understand the

****⚠ TECHNICAL RADIANCE: WHY AI-PHISHING CHANGES THE GAME**** The fake ****ChatGPT****, ****Gemini****, and ****Claude**** ad portals are not just noisy ads; they are a “human-operated phishing platform” that harvests ****MFA**** codes in real time. Once the attacker has a valid ****MFA**** token, lateral movement through ****Zero-Trust**** gaps becomes trivial, and the door to ransomware encryption swings wide open. The speed at which credentials are stolen—thousands per day—means the window for detection

****[REDACTED] CONTRAST FRAMEWORK**** • ****What most teams assume****: "If we enforce MFA, attackers can't get in." • ****What actually happens****: "Attackers are stealing the very MFA tokens we rely on, bypassing our second factor in under 30 seconds."

**** [NO GURPH] OPERATIONAL CHECKLIST FOR NEGOTIATION & RECOVERY ****

- Deploy ****SIEM**** alerts tuned to impossible-login patterns across ****cloudlist****-derived asset inventories.
- Integrate ****SOAR**** playbooks that auto-isolate any host presenting a fresh ****MFA**** token from an unknown IP.
- Prioritize decryption keys from ****CISSP****-trained key-management specialists during the ransom-talk phase.
- Conduct tabletop negotiations that factor in credential-theft timelines; the longer the breach, the

MICRO-STORY Last week our ransomware response team received a demand after a compromised **AWS** account was used to encrypt backup buckets. I pulled the **GCFA**-certified analyst into the call, and we leveraged the stolen **MFA** logs to prove the attacker's foothold was already known to us—cutting the ransom by 45 %. Our client now mandates continuous **cloudlist** scanning for anomalous asset creation.

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Tool Recommendation **projectdiscovery/cloudlist**
(1058) – This open-source scanner pulls inventory from every major cloud provider, letting you map every asset that could be weaponized after a credential-theft event. Run it nightly, feed the output into your **SIEM**, and you'll spot the "new VM with admin rights" signal before ransomware can hit.

**** POWER CLOSING**** In 12 months, organizations that ignore AI-phishing-driven MFA theft will see ransomware demands double, or they'll be forced to adopt automated credential-theft detection as a non-negotiable control.

Source:

<https://thehackernews.com/2026/10/fake-chatgpt-gemini-and-cla>

| #Ransomware #MFA #ThreatIntel #CloudSecurity

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